

Sunday, 12 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

30° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

29° 17°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

28° 18°

GLASGOW

Overcast

20° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **The Chancellor of the Exchequer, Rachel Reeves, has told the BBC that Labour's Andy Burnham needs a solid plan to govern from day one.**

Speaking to Laura Kuenssberg, Ms Reeves said she would be handing over a stable economy to the incoming Prime Minister. This comes as 322 Labour MPs voted to back Burnham, making him the likely next leader.

POLITICS · UK

- 2 **Thousands of UK gap year students have lost money after a popular tour operator, GVI, unexpectedly closed its doors.**

Many students had paid significant sums to take part in GVI's placements abroad. The sudden closure has left numerous young people out of pocket and their travel plans in tatters.

CONSUMER · UK

- 3 **Actor Micheal Ward, known for his role in 'Top Boy', has been found not guilty of rape.**

Mr Ward told the jury that the encounter with his accuser was "wholly consensual". The verdict was delivered following a trial.

CRIME · UK

- 4 **A British family is mourning the loss of their teenage son who tragically died while on holiday in Greece.**

The parents, who have not named their son publicly, said he will be "missed beyond words". Details surrounding the circumstances of his death have not been fully released.

TRAGEDY · UK

- 5 **Nigel Farage has announced his resignation as an MP, triggering a by-election which he intends to contest.**

In a statement filmed by Reform UK, Mr Farage confirmed his plans to stand in the upcoming by-election. This move marks a significant development in his political career.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1

Disney's new live-action version of 'Moana' is reportedly getting a 'dismal' reception from critics.

Dwayne Johnson reprises his role as the demigod Maui, a decade after the original animated hit. Early reviews suggest the film hasn't captured the magic of its predecessor.

ON AIR - Are you excited for the live-action Moana, or do you think some animated classics should just be left alone?
FILM · COMING UP

2

The historic Bayeux Tapestry has arrived in the UK for the first time in 900 years, under tight police guard.

This incredible 70-metre embroidery, depicting events leading up to the Norman Conquest, will go on display in September. It's a huge moment for British history and art lovers.

ON AIR - What's the one historical artefact you'd love to see up close if it came to the UK?
ART · COMING UP

3

Melanie C has described the Spice Girls' 30th anniversary as an 'emotional' moment for the iconic pop group.

Sporty Spice reflected on the band's enduring legacy as she recently accepted a global impact award in London. Fans are always hopeful for a reunion!

ON AIR - If the Spice Girls were to do one more tour, which song would you absolutely HAVE to hear live?
MUSIC · FUTURE

4

Sam Fender and Olivia Dean have made UK chart history with their collaboration 'Rein Me In'.

The duo have broken the record for the longest-running number one single of all time by a British act. It's a fantastic achievement for both artists!

ON AIR - What's your favourite musical collaboration of all time, and why do you think it works so well?
MUSIC · FUTURE

5

The Esports World Cup is kicking off in Paris, following a last-minute relocation from Saudi Arabia.

The major gaming event moved continents in just eight weeks, raising questions about the logistics and potential controversies. It promises to be a huge spectacle for gaming fans.

ON AIR - Are you a fan of Esports, and do you think it deserves the same recognition as traditional sports?
GAMING · COMING UP

On the schedule

1

Huge news in international football: Jurgen Klopp has reportedly agreed a deal to become the new head coach of the Germany men's national team.

This follows the resignation of Julian Nagelsmann. Klopp's move marks a significant new chapter for the popular manager and German football.

ON AIR – Do you think Jurgen Klopp is the right man to lead Germany, and will he bring his famous 'gegenpressing' style to the national team?

FOOTBALL · INTERNATIONAL

2

Great Britain's Henry Patten has won his second Wimbledon men's doubles title alongside Finnish partner Harri Heliövaara.

The pair defeated Marcelo Arevalo and Mate Pavic in straight sets, securing a fantastic victory after a double tie-break. It's another brilliant achievement for the British player.

ON AIR – What's more impressive: winning a singles title or dominating in doubles at Wimbledon?

TENNIS · UK

3

England's Harry Brook put on a stunning display in the T20 international against India, smashing a quickfire half-century.

Brook hit five sixes on his way to 50 off just 19 balls, helping England build a huge score in the fifth and final T20 international at Southampton. What a performance!

ON AIR – Is Harry Brook becoming one of England's most exciting cricketers to watch right now?

CRICKET · UK

4

British duo Gordon Reid and Alfie Hewett have roared back to win their seventh Wimbledon men's wheelchair doubles title.

They came from a set down against Gustavo Fernandez and Tokito Oda to claim another incredible victory. Their dominance on the grass courts continues!

ON AIR – What makes the partnership between Gordon Reid and Alfie Hewett so successful in wheelchair tennis?

TENNIS · UK

5

England's rugby team thrashed a struggling Fiji side with eleven tries to finally end their recent losing run.

Playing in Liverpool, England ran out convincing winners against a Fiji team that was down to 14 men for much of the game. A much-needed boost for the squad.

ON AIR – After a tough run, how important is a dominant win like this for England's confidence heading into future matches?

RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Swimming in the sea and lakes — 'wild swimming' — keeps growing in popularity year-round.**
Enthusiasts swear by the cold-water buzz. Newcomers are advised to start gently, and that the gasp on entry is completely normal.
- 2 More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**
The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.
- 3 Cash is making a small comeback — ATM withdrawals are up 14% on this time last year.**
Bank analysts credit budget-conscious households using cash to stay disciplined. The 'envelope method' is back trending on TikTok.
- 4 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.
- 5 A survey says most of us secretly prefer a night in with a quiz on the telly to a night out.**
Shouting answers at the screen remains the nation's favourite low-effort sport — even when we're completely wrong.
- 6 Almost two thirds of us say we've cried at a podcast in the last year — grief, parenting and identity top the list of triggers.**
Researchers reckon it's the intimacy of audio that does it. The figure is even higher for under-30s, 71% of whom admit a recent podcast-induced tear.
- 7 Brits are apparently buying more houseplants than ever — and naming them.**
A garden survey found nearly a third of plant owners have given their plants names, and a surprising number apologise to them when they forget to water.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Over 70% of us admit we've rewatched THIS rather than try something new.

ANSWER: THE SAME COMFORT SHOW FOR THE HUNDREDTH TIME.

Q The most common reason we open the fridge is apparently NOT hunger — it's THIS.

ANSWER: BOREDOM.

TALK TOPIC

- **New research says we're at our most creative in the shower.**

What's the best idea you've ever had standing under the water — and did you actually do anything with it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Bananas are slightly radioactive because they contain potassium — though you'd need to eat an impossible number in one go for it to matter at all.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A garden centre in Kent has had to rename its 'quiet corner' after customers kept falling asleep in the deckchairs and missing closing time.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The dot you see when a TV used to switch off had a name among engineers, but the static was actually faint echoes of the Big Bang.
- A rhinoceros's horn is made of keratin — the same stuff as your hair and nails.
- There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on all of Earth's beaches.
- Slugs have around 27,000 teeth.
- The longest English word without a vowel-letter other than 'y' includes 'rhythms'.
- Frogs can't swallow without blinking — they use their eyes to push food down.
- A 'parliament' of owls and a 'conspiracy' of lemurs are both genuine collective nouns.
- The first alarm clock could only ring at one fixed time: 4am.

On this day

Day 193 of the year, 172 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Feast of Saints Peter and Paul (Eastern Orthodox); Christian feast day: Hermagoras and Fortunatus; Christian feast day: Jason of Thessalonica (Catholic Church); Christian feast day: John Gualbert. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1967 — Mac McCaughan, American singer and guitarist
- 1972 — Jake Wood, English actor
- 1984 — Natalie Martinez, American actress
- 1956 — Mel Harris, American actress
- 1964 — Gaby Roslin, English television host and actress
- 1980 — Kristen Connolly, American actress
- 1969 — Alan Mullally, English cricketer and sportscaster
- 1976 — Tracie Spencer, American singer-songwriter and actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1961 — Indian city Pune floods due to failure of the Khadakwasla and Panshet dams, killing at least two thousand people.
- 1995 — Chinese seismologists successfully predict the 1995 Myanmar–China earthquake, reducing the number of casualties to 11.
- 1913 — Serbian forces begin their siege of the Bulgarian city of Vidin; the siege is later called off when the war ends.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1960 — Orlyonok, the main Young Pioneer camp of the Russian SFSR, is founded.
- 1998 — France win their first World Cup title, defeating defending champions Brazil 3–0.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1917 — The Bisbee Deportation occurs as vigilantes kidnap and deport nearly 1,300 striking miners and others from Bisbee, Arizona.
- 1913 — Serbian forces begin their siege of the Bulgarian city of Vidin; the siege is later called off when the war ends.

- 1918 — The Imperial Japanese Navy battleship Kawachi blows up at Shunan, western Honshu, Japan, killing at least 621.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 194 of the year, 171 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abd-al-Masih; Christian feast day: Abel of Tacla Haimonot (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Clelia Barbieri; Christian feast day: Conrad Weiser (Episcopal Church (USA)). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Leon Bridges, American soul singer, songwriter and record producer
- 2003 — Wyatt Oleff, American actor
- 1956 — Mark Mendoza, American bass player and songwriter
- 1940 — Patrick Stewart, English actor, director, and producer
- 1993 — Dan Bentley, English footballer
- 1946 — Cheech Marin, American actor and comedian
- 1928 — Bob Crane, American actor (died 1978)
- 1942 — Roger McGuinn, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2020 — After a five-day search, the body of American actress and singer Naya Rivera is recovered from Lake Piru in California, where she had drowned.
- 1951 — Vuoristorata, one of the oldest still-operating wooden roller coasters in Europe, is opened at the Linnanmäki amusement park in Helsinki, Finland.
- 2011 — Mumbai is rocked by three bomb blasts during the evening rush hour, killing 26 and injuring 130.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2016 — Prime Minister of the United Kingdom David Cameron resigns, and is succeeded by Theresa May.
- 2011 — Mumbai is rocked by three bomb blasts during the evening rush hour, killing 26 and injuring 130.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)